

ROOTSTOCK

A seasonal American restaurant rooted in where the food comes from.

Cynthia Thornton, Chef-Owner
Jersey City / Hoboken, NJ

The Idea

40 seats. Open kitchen. A menu that changes with the farms, not the trends.

An a la carte room with an optional five-course tasting menu. Honest, ingredient-driven food built on my grandmother's recipes and fifteen years on professional lines.

Why Me

Sous Chef at Harborview Kitchen since 2022, running the line under Chef Gianna Caruso.

Culinary Arts diploma, Hudson Valley Culinary Academy. Stages in Portland.

I already source direct from Greenfield Farm Market, Fontana Creamery, and Fulton Fish Market.

The supplier relationships exist today.

The Market

Jersey City and Hoboken: high-income, food-literate diners, one PATH stop from Manhattan.
Room for an ingredient-driven tasting concept that is neither a steakhouse nor a trend-chasing small-plates room.

Location

Lead candidate: 214 Elm Street, Hoboken. 1,650 sq ft, second-generation restaurant, hood and grease trap in place, eight minutes from the PATH.

Eight spaces evaluated and ranked. Viewing scheduled for October 26, 2026.

The Numbers

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Revenue	\$1,150,000	\$1,380,000	\$1,520,000
Net Operating Income	\$75,000	\$172,000	\$226,000
Net Margin	6.5%	12.5%	14.9%

Break-even at roughly 233 covers per week. Food cost target 30 percent.

The Ask

Seeking \$250,000 for a 30 percent equity stake.

Owner equity (Rootstock fund)	\$50,000
SBA 7(a) loan	\$165,000
Investor equity (you, 30%)	\$250,000
Total project	\$465,000

Timeline

Lease and financing by Q1 2027. Buildout Q2 2027. Open Q3 2027.

Food is the most honest thing we make. Let's build something real.

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